

Fantine XIAO

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Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics, Gender Economics

Education

Erasmus University Rotterdam

PhD Candidate in Economics

Advisors: Dr. Anne Boring and Prof. Chen Li

2023 - Present
Rotterdam, the Netherlands

Tinbergen Institute

Research Master in Economics

2021-2023
Amsterdam, the Netherlands

Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich

Master in Quantitative Economics (Completed Courses)

2019-2021
Munich, Germany

University of Hong Kong

Bachelor of Economics and Finance, Minor in Mathematics

2014-2019
Hong Kong SAR

Work in Progress

1. Emotional Communication and Trust: Valence, Beliefs, and Ambiguity Attitudes

Job Market Paper

Abstract: This project studies whether opportunities to communicate a trustor's emotions affect trust behavior in a modified trust game. I also investigate whether the impact of emotional communication varies by valence (positive or negative) and by the flexibility of emotional communication (restricted to sending one valence or free to choose between two valences). In an online experiment with 400 participants, I elicit trustors' trust decisions, ambiguity attitudes, and beliefs using the belief hedge method. The results suggest that access to emotional communication has limited average effects on trust, while greater flexibility in emotional communication leads to greater willingness to trust and higher ambiguity insensitivity.

2. Anger as Signal: Decomposing the Affective, Inferential, and Ambiguity Channels in Negotiation

with David Gonzalez-Jimenez and Chen Li

Abstract:

This study examines how anger expression shapes negotiation decisions by affecting altruism, signaling counterparts' reservation prices, and influencing perceived ambiguity. We also investigate whether these effects depend on counterpart gender. Participants acted as proposers in ultimatum and dictator games, splitting a \$20 endowment with counterparts whose gender (male vs. female) and emotional expression (anger vs. neutral) were experimentally manipulated. Beliefs and ambiguity attitudes were elicited using the belief hedge method, and altruism was measured via dictator game allocations. Anger reduced altruism and perceived ambiguity only for male counterparts, while increasing expected reservation prices for counterparts of both genders in the ultimatum game. These opposing effects canceled out, resulting in no net change in final offers. Beliefs and perceived ambiguity predicted the gap between ultimatum and dictator offers, showing that participants strategically integrated emotional cues.

3. The Necessity to Reconcile Choice Inconsistencies and the Dangers to Do It Mechanistically

with Chen Li, Julia Rose and Peter Wakker

Abstract: Decision theory has rarely been prescriptive because consultants cannot reliably detect and correct axiom violations in complex preferences. Building on Nielsen & Rehbeck (2022), we propose the low-bar (lb) criterion, requiring procedures to beat blind random choice. We prove that many popular reconciliation methods are lb and can worsen decisions, sometimes inducing expected utility minimization. We analyze four reconciliation procedures, resolve a reconciliation paradox, and show that in many cases overruling preferences is necessary because less invasive methods are lb. In a preregistered replication using corrected procedures, we find that participants often misunderstand axioms under time pressure. Nielsen and Rehbeck's high endorsement rates likely reflect demand effects. This paper identifies new hurdles in prescriptive decision theory and provides solutions.

Conference and Workshop Presentations (Scheduled)

Economic Science Association (ESA) Barcelona, Spain	<i>September 2026</i>
International Meeting on Experimental and Behavioural Social Sciences (IMEBESS) Prague, Czech Republic	<i>July 2026</i>
Foundations of Utility and Risk (FUR) Alicante, Spain	<i>June 2026</i>
Bayesian Peternalism Workshop Rotterdam, the Netherlands	<i>May 2026</i>

Seminars

Behavioral, Organization and Market Seminar Erasmus School of Economics, EUR	<i>2026</i>
PhD Lunch Seminar Erasmus School of Economics, EUR	<i>2026</i>
Behavioral Group Meeting Erasmus School of Economics, EUR	<i>2025</i>

Teaching Experience

Erasmus University Rotterdam

2024-2026 Behavioral Economics (Bachelor, Year 3)	Lecturer
2023/2024 Experimental Economics (Master's)	Lecturer
2023-2026 Behavioral Economics (Bachelor, Year 3)	Lecturer
2023-2026 Behavioral Economics (Master's Theses x 12)	Supervisor
2023-2026 Behavioral Economics (Bachelor's Theses x 14)	Supervisor

Tinbergen Institute

2022/2023 Microeconomics I: Individual Decision Making (Master's)	Teaching Assistant
2022/2023 Microeconomics II: Game Theory (Master's)	Teaching Assistant

Languages

English (fluent), Chinese (native), Korean (intermediate).